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Sources of Pamfil Yurkevych's Philosophical and Religious Concept of the Heart

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Abstract

The purpose of the study is to identify the features of philosophical and religious understanding of cognition in the concept Pamfil Yurkevych. An analysis of the primary sources containing his key ideas is conducted. The methodological basis of the study is the analytical and comparative methods used to review the conceptual provisions of Yurkevych and their correlation with theological traditions. The historical and philosophical method allowed tracing the influence of his ideas on the development of philosophy of the 19th-20th centuries, and the hermeneutical approach contributed to a deeper understanding of his works in the context of moral choice and spiritual knowledge. The study establishes that the philosophy of Yurkevych differs substantially from classical rationalistic concepts, which focus on logical analysis as the main way to comprehend the truth. It is determined that the key place in his concept was occupied by subjective experience and intuitive perception of reality, which brought him closer to non-classical trends such as existentialism, intuitionism, and phenomenology. Analysis of his concept in the context of Orthodox anthropology confirms that it contains elements of a mystical understanding of knowledge. The study shows that his teaching remains relevant to modern philosophical thought and has substantial potential for interdisciplinary research.

Keywords: Existentialism, Hesychasm, Phenomenology, Theological Tradition, Intuitionism.

Introduction

The relevance of the study is determined by the need for a deeper understanding of the processes of forming a non-classical philosophical paradigm. Despite existing research, the

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concept of Pamfil Yurkevych (1826-1874) needs further review in connection with his Eastern Christian roots, in particular, the teaching of Hesychasm.

Within the framework of axiological analysis of the concept of the soul in the philosophical works of Yurkevych, Masiuk (2021) explored its ethical dimension, emphasising the connection between the ontological and moral aspects of human existence. The question of the identity of the Ukrainian philosophical tradition was explored by Kulyk (2022), who noted that Yurkevych became one of those scholars who integrated the spiritual traditions of Orthodoxy into the philosophical system, contrasting it with the rationalism of the West. The study on the concepts of “heart” and “soul” in the phraseological worldview of Ukrainian culture was conducted by Anisimova and Repp (2021), who showed that conventional understanding of these concepts is deeply rooted in folklore.

The non-classical philosophical paradigm, which emerged in the 19th-20th centuries, was the subject of analysis in the paper of Karipbayev et al. (2022). The conclusions noted that Yurkevych foresaw many ideas that later became central to existentialism and phenomenology. The problem of transformation of the concept of “heart” in philosophy was investigated by Källgren and Ferran (2022), who showed that the heart in the philosophical and religious tradition can be considered a centre of moral improvement and spiritual development. Criticism of logocentrism as the basis of classical philosophy has become the subject of publications by Menegalle (2023) and Arnaud (2021). They found that logocentrism, being the dominant concept in classical philosophy, was gradually criticised in the non-classical tradition, which opened the way for new forms of thinking, including those proposed by Yurkevych.

In the field of non-classical directions of 20th-century philosophy, questions of existential phenomenology were examined by Pedersen et al. (2021), who showed that this approach combines subjective experience with metaphysical searches, which is related to the philosophical and religious concept of the heart of Yurkevych. Moral philosophy as a component of non-classical discourse was evaluated in the work of Hansson (2022), where the author analysed the ethical principles of decision-making and emphasised the need to consider not only rational arguments but also intuitive moral sense. In turn, Wiseman (2022) investigated the influence of emotional factors on moral judgments, noting that they are instrumental in determining a person’s ethical guidelines.

The study aimed to analyse Pamfil Yurkevych's philosophical and religious concept of heart in the context of the formation of a non-classical philosophical paradigm, trace its influence on further philosophical trends, and establish its connection with the Eastern Christian tradition. The following tasks were set to achieve the stated purpose:

- consider the main provisions of Yurkevych's teaching on the concepts of the heart;
- analyse the philosophical and religious concept of the heart in the context of the formation of a non-classical philosophical paradigm;
- study the influence of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart on non-classical trends in 20th-century philosophy;
- establish the relationship between the philosophical and religious concept of the heart and Hesychasm;
- determine the importance of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart for modern philosophical thought.

Materials and Methods

The material basis of the study was the works of fundamental philosophers and theologians, who had a direct impact on the formation and development of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart. Several sources were analysed, including the publication of Yurkevych “Selected Works. The Idea – The Heart – Reason and Experience” (1984). This work was chosen for the study, as it allows tracing the main ideological foundations of the concept of Yurkevych and determining its place in the philosophical tradition. Another important source

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was the book of Hegel “Phenomenology of Spirit” (1998). It is a classical work that represents the pinnacle of European logocentrism, which was indirectly opposed by Yurkevych. The work of Husserl “The Crisis of European Sciences and Transcendental Phenomenology” (1970) was also considered. Another source analysed was Saint Gregory Palamas’ “The Triads” (1983). The choice of this text was determined by the need to establish a relationship between the philosophical and religious concept of the heart and the Orthodox spiritual tradition.

The hermeneutical method was used to analyse the main provisions of Pamfil Yurkevych's teaching. The review of primary sources provided for the reconstruction of the main theses of the philosopher regarding the nature of the heart as the centre of human existence. Historical and philosophical analysis was also used. The key provisions of classical philosophy presented in Hegel's works were compared with non-classical approaches.

The influence of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart on the non-classical directions of philosophy of the 20th century was assessed using a systematic method. The way certain ideas of Yurkevych intersect with the views of representatives of phenomenological and existential traditions was evaluated. The breakdown of the relationship between the philosophical and religious concept of the heart and Hesychasm was conducted through theological analysis. Establishing parallels between Hesychasm and the philosophical anthropology of Yurkevych became possible due to the methods of comparative studies and theological hermeneutics.

Results and Discussion

The main provisions of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart in the teachings of Pamfil Yurkevych

Pamfil Yurkevych created a philosophical and religious concept in which the heart appears not only as a physiological organ but also as the centre of a person’s spiritual, moral, and cognitive life. In his book “Selected Works. The Idea – the Heart-Reason and Experience” (1984), the heart was regarded as a key element of human nature, performing the function of preserving and knowing the highest moral and spiritual truths.

According to the teaching of Yurkevych, the heart is the concentration of the human essence, which provides a direct connection of a person with the transcendent world. Unlike the rational mind, which analyses, logically structures, and classifies knowledge, the heart is able to comprehend the truth holistically, through feeling and inner spiritual experience (Bazarbayeva et al., 2024; Mukhtarova et al., 2024). Yurkevych underlined that morality is not the result of formal logic or rational calculations, but is formed through the inner experience of good. The inner state of a person, their feelings and experiences are not secondary or interfering with knowledge, but on the contrary – they form the basis of the process of moral recognition of good and evil (Temirbolat et al., 2016).

Yurkevych emphasised that the heart not only determines the moral state of a person but is also an active participant in the process of cognition. He argued that human cognition is not limited to purely intellectual understanding, but includes inner intuition, which is realised through the heart. Knowledge gained through the heart is more holistic than analytical knowledge since it encompasses not only logical structures but also intuitive comprehension of truth. In this process, emotional experience, spiritual concentration, and an individual's state of being are of great importance.

In the concept of Yurkevych’s heart acts not only as the centre of a person’s moral and cognitive life but also as the main channel of communication with the divine. This idea had a deep connection with Eastern Christian anthropology, in particular, with the tradition of Hesychasm. In the Orthodox tradition, the heart was considered the abode of the Holy Spirit, which manifests itself in inner prayer and spiritual purification (Kassymova et al., 2025).

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The philosophical and religious concept of the heart in the teaching of Yurkevych combined three key aspects: spiritual, moral, and aesthetic. Yurkevych argued that truth, goodness, and beauty are interrelated. Knowledge of truth through the heart is impossible without the moral improvement of a person, just as truth cannot be perceived without awareness of its beauty (Stadnik, 2024).

The concept developed by Yurkevych defines the heart as a key element of human nature, providing knowledge, moral improvement, and spiritual unity with God. Bilchuk and Kolotova (2021) analyse the concept of the heart as the basis for the formation of spirituality, emphasising its importance in the moral formation of the individual. Researchers point out that the heart performs not only the function of an emotional centre but is a vital mechanism through which a person perceives metaphysical and religious truths. This thesis echoes the statements of Yurkevych, claiming that the heart provides an intuitive comprehension of the truth.

The main provisions of this concept include the idea of the heart as a centre of moral life, a source of intuitive knowledge, and a mystical connection with the transcendental world. Yurkevych showed that the heart is not just a sense organ, but an active participant in the process of cognition, which allows a person to comprehend the truth holistically. From the standpoint of the Ukrainian philosophical tradition, the concept of the heart plays a special role as the basis for the moral and spiritual existence of a person. Brodetska (2023) accentuates that the concept of the heart is not limited to individual experience, but functions as a form of “koinonia”, that is, a joint spiritual life based on a deep inner connection between man, God, and community. This approach allows considering the teachings of Yurkevych not only as part of non-classical philosophy but also as a component of a broader national and cultural phenomenon that shaped Ukrainian cultural identity.

Philosophical and religious concept of the heart in the context of the formation of a non-classical philosophical paradigm

The philosophical and religious concept of the heart, formulated by Yurkevych, played a substantial role in the formation of a non-classical philosophical paradigm. It was one of the first manifestations of a departure from the rigid rationalism of the European classical tradition, which focused on logical and analytical ways of knowing. Yurkevych proposed a different approach, that reflected the main features of the future non-classical discourse formed in the 20th century. In particular, in existentialism, phenomenology, and intuitionism, a gradual distancing from the rational-analytical model of cognition, and increased attention to subjective experience, intuition could be observed. Yurkevych considered cognition as a process that includes thinking and direct spiritual experience, which is the basis of moral choice. For example, Chernus (2021) suggests considering intentionality as a phenomenon that is not limited to the cognitive direction of consciousness but includes existential experience, emotional states, and moral choices. This is in line with the approach of Yurkevych, who underlined that cognition is a multidimensional process.

An equally important aspect of non-classical philosophy is the revision of the principles of classical dialectics, which reached its peak in the system of Hegel, who in “Phenomenology of Spirit” (1998) considered cognition as a process of self-development of the spirit through the dialectical overcoming of contradictions. His system involved the gradual disclosure of absolute truth through the logical interaction of theses, antithesis, and synthesis (Hong, 2023). However, after Hegel's death, his philosophy underwent numerous interpretations that handled its connection to rationalism and metaphysics in different ways. Latifi (2024) draws attention to the fact that Hegel's critics often simplified his system, reducing it only to rational constructivism. In turn, non-classical thinkers, in particular, Yurkevych, expressed concern about the limitations of the rationalistic approach to knowledge.

Analysing the development of Hegelian philosophy, modern researchers emphasise its connection with natural science ideas and its transformation in non-classical discourse. Redding (2024) highlights the Hegelian dialectics is based not only on the logical development

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of concepts but also on an attempt to account for the natural order that affects the formation of knowledge. This approach, however, does not consider that Yurkevych called direct moral and spiritual experience. Therefore, the criticism of Yurkevych's view of the dominance of logical necessity in the Hegelian system becomes even more relevant in the context of the modern reinterpretation of his legacy.

In contrast to Hegelian dialectics, which was based on objective laws of the development of the spirit, the concept of Yurkevych was based on the subjective experience of truth through the heart. He rejected the idea that truth can be achieved solely through the logical evolution of concepts and argued that moral knowledge has a different nature. Yurkevych also denied the universality of Hegel's rationalism, because he believed that it did not consider a person's personal experience. This approach had a substantial impact on non-classical philosophy, which later formed such trends as existentialism and phenomenology (Figure 1).

Yurkevich	Hegel
Main principle	
Philosophical and religious concept of the heart	Dialectical idealism
Cognition centre	
The heart as a centre of knowledge	Mind as a centre of knowledge
Method of cognition	
Intuitive and ethical approach	Dialectical method
The role of consciousness	
Consciousness integrates with spiritual experience	Consciousness as part of the historical development of the spirit
Spiritual dimension	
The heart as a means of spiritual comprehension	Absolute idea as the basis of reality
Moral knowledge	
Morality is formed through the inner experience of good	Morality follows from the development of the spirit through rational knowledge
Philosophical tradition	
Ukrainian spiritual and philosophical tradition, Orthodox theology	German idealism, classical European philosophy

Figure 1. Comparison of aspects of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart by Yurkevych and dialectical idealism of Hegel

Source: compiled by the authors based on Farias de Sousa and Marcelo Hungaro (2021), Hegel (1998), Yurkevych (1984).

The philosophy of Yurkevych contained a moral, ethical, and aesthetic dimension that substantially distinguished it from the classical systems of modern times. He saw the heart as the centre of human morality, through which a person knows the good and distinguishes between right and wrong actions. In this aspect, his teaching coincides with non-classical approaches of the 20th century, in particular, existentialism. In addition, he believed that truth

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is revealed not only through logical analysis but also through beauty and harmony perceived by the heart. This approach was later developed in aesthetic phenomenology and Christian existentialism (Masiuk, 2021). His idea of the heart as a centre of moral and spiritual knowledge opposed classical rationalism and influenced the development of new directions of philosophy.

Influence of the philosophical and religious concept of the heart on the non-classical directions of philosophy of the 20th century

Pamfil Yurkevych's philosophical and religious concept of heart, which justifies knowledge as a combination of moral, spiritual, and emotional experience, played an important role in the formation of non-classical trends in 20th-century philosophy. Its key positions about the heart as a centre of moral choice, intuitive knowledge, and experience of truth are in tune with the basic ideas of existentialism, intuitionism, and phenomenology.

One of the directions of non-classical philosophy that developed ideas about the importance of inner experience in cognition was existentialism (Yespenbetov et al., 2024). Existentialism defines a person as a being who forms their own essence through freedom of choice and action and is not a carrier of a pre-defined essence (Jeong et al., 2024). Its representatives – Martin Heidegger, Jean-Paul Sartre, Gabriel Marcel – focused on the individual experience of being, the need for personal choice, and the search for the meaning of life. Heidegger considered human existence as “being-toward-death”. Sartre, in turn, stressed that a person is “doomed to be free” because they do not have a pre-defined essence. Marcel focused on the religious and ethical aspects of existence.

In the concept of Yurkevych’s heart is the centre of moral decision, which determines the direction of human development. This is similar to the existential idea of freedom of choice, which implies responsibility for decisions made. In contrast to classical rationalistic philosophy, where cognition is based on objective laws, existentialism and the concept of Yurkevych are recognised for the uniqueness of each human existence and the individuality of their experience. In the traditions of Eastern Christianity, faith is not a simple acceptance of dogmatic truths, but a deep personal experience that occurs through the heart.

Another direction of non-classical philosophy, which developed the ideas of Yurkevych, became intuitivism, represented by Henri Bergson, William James, and Henri Bremont. Intuitionism is a philosophical trend that justifies knowledge through direct intuitive comprehension of the truth, as opposed to the rational-analytical method. Henri Bergson believed that the human mind can only perceive static forms, while reality is a dynamic process that can only be understood through intuition. William James, a representative of American pragmatism, believed that truth is formed in the process of human interaction with the world, and cognition is dynamic and dependent on the internal state of the subject. Henri Bremont, a French philosopher and theologian, in his works, considered intuition as the main tool of mystical experience and spiritual knowledge. Intuitionism has denied the absolute dominance of rational thinking in philosophy, offering an alternative way of knowing in which experience, intuition, and inner spiritual experience play the main role (Rzepa, 2021). This made it related to the philosophical and religious concept of the heart of Yurkevych, who also reinforced the role of inner experience in the process of learning the truth.

In the philosophy of Yurkevych, heart acts as the main organ of intuitive cognition, which allows a person to perceive the truth directly, without going through the path of rational analysis. Yurkevych considered intuition as a means of understanding higher spiritual truths that cannot be derived from abstract principles or logical constructions. Yurkevych insists that intuitive knowledge through the heart leads a person to the truth, which is revealed through direct experience of moral goodness, beauty, and harmony rather than deductive or inductive methods.

Phenomenology founded by Husserl, became one of the key non-classical areas of philosophy, which developed ideas about direct perception and the essential experience of a person. Husserl sought to create a methodology that would allow analysing phenomena as they are

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perceived by consciousness, regardless of external conceptual constructs. In the Crisis of European Sciences and Transcendental Phenomenology (1970), he proposed a method of phenomenological reduction that involved abstracting from all previous ideas about reality and focusing on experience as the main source of knowledge. This meant that truth is not something external but is revealed to man in their own experiences (Gallagher, 2022).

Yurkevych's philosophical and religious concept of the heart also emphasised the importance of direct experience in the process of cognition. Unlike the purely rational approach to cognition, which is limited to logic and abstract schemes, cognition through the heart encompasses a deeper dimension of human existence, including moral intuition, spiritual comprehension, and existential experience.

Both scholars focused on subjective experience as the basis of cognition (Table 1).

Table 1. Comparative analysis of Husserl's phenomenological approach and Yurkevych's philosophical and religious concept of the heart

Aspect	Phenomenology (Husserl)	Yurkevych	Common features	Differences
Conceptual approach	Research of subjective acts of consciousness	Integration of philosophical and religious understanding of cognition	The defining role of subjective experience in the process of cognition	Phenomenology focuses on the analysis of consciousness, Yurkevych concentrates on the moral and religious dimension of cognition
Methodology	Phenomenological reduction, rejection of external judgments	Comprehension of knowledge through the inner moral and spiritual state	The direct connection between the acquisition of truth	Husserl uses the reduction method, Yurkevych considers knowledge as an integral spiritual process
The value of personal experience	Consciousness forms the perception of reality	The heart is the key centre of feeling and understanding being	Personal experience determines the process of cognition	For phenomenology, personal experience is structured by consciousness, in Yurkevych's theory, the heart is the direct bearer of truth
The role of feelings and sensory perception	Includes analysis of emotions, memories, and sensations	It covers not only the emotional but also the spiritual-intuitive sphere	The importance of experiences in building understanding	. Husserl analyses feelings and emotions, and Yurkevych includes spiritual intuition in his outlook on perception
Ethical and religious dimension	It is not a key aspect of the phenomenological method	The central role of moral and spiritual transformation	Recognition of the multi-vector nature of the cognition process	Phenomenology is value-neutral, while Yurkevych emphasises the moral component of knowledge
Knowledge structure	It is determined by the direction of consciousness	It is formed through the prism of moral choice and faith	Denial of the conventional rationalistic concept	Husserl stresses the intentionality of consciousness, Yurkevych focuses on moral choice as

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				the basis of knowledge
Key idea	Consciousness as a basis for analysing phenomena	The heart as a centre of awareness of moral truth	Recognising the importance of inner awareness	Husserl examines the structure of consciousness, and Yurkevych considers the heart as an organ of transcendental knowledge

Source: compiled by the author based on Gallagher (2022), Yurkevych (1984), Husserl (1970).

Husserl and Yurkevych moved away from the conventional rationalism that dominated classical philosophy and recognised that truth is not a purely logical construct but is learned through personal experience. They also reaffirm that objective reality is revealed only through subjective experience, which makes a person an active participant in the cognitive process, and not a passive observer.

Despite some common views, the approaches of these two philosophers had substantial differences. Husserl built his phenomenology as a rigorous methodological approach that sought to clear consciousness of previous concepts and explore phenomena in their original reality. Yurkevych, on the other hand, did not create a methodological approach in the strict sense but formulated a philosophical and religious concept in which the heart was the main centre of true knowledge. Another important difference is that Husserl did not give knowledge a moral or religious dimension but considered it as a phenomenological process. Yurkevych, on the contrary, claimed that knowledge is impossible without moral improvement and spiritual adjustment of a person.

Yurkevych's concept of the heart significantly influenced 20th-century non-classical philosophy. It shaped existentialism's focus on personal choice and faith, echoed intuitionism's idea of truth through the heart, and aligned with phenomenology's emphasis on lived experience.

Philosophy of the heart and Hesychasm in the theological aspect of humanities

Hesychasm is a theological and spiritual tradition of Eastern Christianity that developed in Byzantium and the Orthodox world in the 4th century and acquired a systematic design in the 14th century due to the works of Gregory Palama. The central principle of Hesychasm is the practice of continuous prayer and inner concentration to achieve unity with God. This mystical tradition is based on the idea that a person can achieve God's vision through the purification of the heart and inner silence (ἡσυχία, Greek: "calm").

The basis of Hesychasm is the Jesus Prayer ("Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, have mercy on me, a sinner"), which is repeated for a long time in a state of spiritual concentration. Gregory Palama, one of the main theologians of Hesychasm, formulated the key principles of this teaching in his work "The Triads" (1983). An in-depth study of Hesychasm as a spiritual practice and its connection to the liturgy demonstrates that inner prayer and purification of the Heart play a central role in the Orthodox tradition. For example, Getcha (2023) proves that Hesychast methods of spiritual concentration have not only an individual dimension but also manifest themselves in a joint liturgical life, which contributes to a deeper experience of the divine.

Palama taught that without becoming one with God's essence, one can experience the God's presence through divine energy, which is manifested as the uncreated light on Mount Tabor. He underlined that is, the knowledge of God is possible only through the integration of the intellectual and spiritual dimensions. In Hesychasm, the heart is the site of spiritual transformation in addition to being an emotional place. According to Haubert (2022), suffering

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strengthens this inner union and purifies the soul, which is consistent with Yurkevych's theory that the heart is the primary organ of moral and spiritual experience. Both these teachings shape important aspects of religious and anthropological thought.

Yurkevych considered the heart as a centre of spiritual knowledge, where the moral, religious, and intuitive merge into a single process of understanding the truth. Like the Hesychast tradition, he believed that the heart is not only responsible for emotions or feelings but is the deep centre of human existence, which determines the connection of a person with higher spiritual realities. Like Palamas, who believed that the human mind must unite with the heart in prayer to achieve true knowledge, Yurkevych argued that the heart is the highest organ of knowledge.

In Hesychasm, the heart is the place where a person's spiritual transformation takes place, which allows them to feel the Divine Light. Gregory Palama believed that only a purified heart can perceive God because sinfulness and passions obscure a person's ability to contemplate God. Yurkevych also considered cleansing the heart as a necessary step in the process of cognition.

According to the Hesychast tradition, knowledge of God is impossible without an inner transformation that occurs through the heart. However, Hesychasm not only accentuates the role of inner prayer but also forms a special religious aesthetic based on the contemplation of "divine light" as a manifestation of transcendental experience. In particular, Kleinhempel (2023) notes that the Hesychast experience is not only a theological but also an aesthetic phenomenon that combines mystical contemplation with a deep inner sense of harmony and light. The same idea can be traced in the philosophy of Yurkevych, stating that the moral and mental state of a person affects their cognition.

The assessment of the relationship between religious texts and philosophical traditions is an important aspect of the research in Eastern Christian anthropology. With this in mind, the work of Lysokolenko (2022) deserves attention. The author analyses how conventional theological concepts, including Hesychasm and the mystical doctrine of the heart, were integrated into philosophical discourses in the context of the Ukrainian spiritual legacy.

In Eastern Christianity, the heart is the meeting place of man with God, and in the teaching of Yurkevych – a key organ of moral intuition and spiritual experience. Both traditions stress that true knowledge is possible only through internal transformation, and not through purely rational understanding.

The importance of the philosophy of the heart for modern philosophical thought

In modern philosophical discourse, there is an interest in the ideas of Yurkevych, especially in the context of philosophical anthropology and religious philosophy. His concept of the heart as a centre of cognition, moral choice, and spiritual experience attracts the attention of researchers who analyse non-classical approaches to understanding human consciousness and morality. Yurkevych also occupies an important place in the philosophy of education.His claims that morality and spirituality are an integral part of human development resonate in modern research in pedagogy, which focuses on the formation of a holistic personality. Schumacher (2022) explores the historical development of the interaction of these two disciplines and offers predictions about their future coexistence. The concept of the heart of Yurkevych as an integrative centre of cognition can be considered in this context as one of the models for overcoming dualism between philosophical and theological ways of thinking.

The philosophical and religious concept of the heart of Yurkevych is relevant in the field of interdisciplinary research that combines philosophy, anthropology, psychology, and theology. In modern anthropology, his approach allows considering man not only as a biological or social being but as a moral and spiritual person. From this standpoint, the study by Torres (2024) demonstrates that modern environmental ethics often borrows concepts from classical

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philosophy but simultaneously faces the challenge of adapting conventional concepts to modern challenges.

The evaluation of the role of the heart in the knowledge of the transcendent goes beyond historical and philosophical studies and takes on a new sound in discussions about the future of religion. For example, McKim (2024) highlights that such categories as spiritual experience, mystical experience, and intuitive knowledge are becoming fundamental in the latest approaches to the philosophy of religion. With this in mind, the philosophical and religious concept of the heart developed by Yurkevych, turns out to be particularly relevant. Thus, the ideas of Yurkevych can serve as a basis for further research on the phenomenology of faith and the role of internal experience in the formation of religious consciousness.

The examination of the philosophy of Yurkevych In this context enabled a fresh look at the issues of mystical experience, prayer, and inner communion with God. A separate direction of modern rethinking of his ideas was the philosophy of law. Thus, in the study by Holovko (2022), the role of moral intuition in the formation of legal consciousness is analysed. Yurkevych considered law not only as a set of formal norms but also as a process of moral self-knowledge that occurs through the heart as a centre of moral choice. This provision is relevant in modern jurisprudence, especially in the context of ethical jurisprudence.

Yurkevych's heart concept has substantial potential for modern humanities, in particular, for the further development of non-classical approaches in philosophy, anthropology, psychology, and religious studies. Sandford (2024) researches how the history of philosophy can be used to rethink established categories of thinking and identify new ways to interpret them. This approach is relevant for the analysis of the philosophy of the heart of Yurkevych, which, despite its historical origin, contains the potential for modern interdisciplinary research. The use of the methodology of the critical history of philosophy can contribute to further understanding of the legacy of Yurkevych in the context of modern studies on consciousness, ethics, and religious philosophy.

Conclusions

The concept of the heart in Yurkevych's teaching played a fundamental role as the centre of the moral, cognitive, and spiritual experience of a person. Yurkevych considered the heart not only as a metaphorical symbol but as a real mechanism through which the understanding of moral truth and transcendent existence took place. The philosophy of the heart of Yurkevych was substantially different from the classical rationalistic traditions that dominated modern philosophy. The concept of the heart Yurkevych was identified to have common features with the Hesychast tradition of Eastern Christianity, particularly with the theological teaching of Gregory Palamas. Both approaches considered the heart as the centre of spiritual life and the mechanism of direct communion with God. The study confirmed that the teaching of Yurkevych could be interpreted in the context of Orthodox anthropology, where the heart played a key role in the moral and religious formation of the individual.

Further research on the concept of the heart Yurkevych should be directed to its more detailed analysis in the context of modern philosophical thought. It is necessary to consider its impact on the development of non-classical philosophical trends, in connection with modern discussions about subjective knowledge, moral intuition, and spiritual experience. Further analysis of Orthodox Anthropology in the light of the teachings of Yurkevych will contribute to a deeper understanding of the spiritual dimension of knowledge in Eastern Christian philosophy.

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